

CASE ID: 201611710712

EPISODE NAME: Dalai Lama Visits Mongolia 2016

2016/11/18 - 2016/12/22

Sender: China (710)

Target: Mongolia (712)

Issue: Terminate Support of Non-State Actors (10)

Final Outcome: Total Acquiescence by Target State following sanctions imposition (7)

Summary:

On 2016/11/18 China warned Mongolia that allowing the Dalai Lama to visit the country would strain relations.¹ Following the spiritual leader's visit between 2016/11/18 and 2016/11/22, China imposed transit fees at an important border crossing and postponed negotiations over economic assistance.²³ These sanctions caused major disruptions in bilateral trade, which resulted in Mongolia announcing that the Dalai Lama would not be invited back to the country.⁴

Narrative:

On 2016/11/17, the Gandan monastery in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia announced that the Dalai Lama would begin a four-day trip to Mongolia on 2016/11/18.⁵ The trip was entirely religious in nature.⁶ In response, China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs urged the Mongolian government to "deny the Dalai Lama a visit for the sake of a 'sound and steady' development of bilateral ties" on 2016/11/18.⁷

To punish Mongolia, China began charging vehicles a transit fee of 10 yuan (\$1.45) at the border crossing in Inner Mongolia, and imposed an additional 8 yuan per ton of any goods carried.⁸ Mongolian exporters were also charged 0.2 percent of the total value of precious metals and

¹ Associated Press. "Dalai Lama's Visit to Mongolia Could Fray Its Ties to China." *New York Times*, November 19th, 2016. https://www.nytimes.com/2016/11/20/world/asia/mongolia-dalai-lama-china.html?_r=0.

² Kohn, Michael. "China Cancels Mongolia Talks Indefinitely After Dalai Lama Visit." *Bloomberg*, November 25th, 2016.

<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2016-11-25/china-cancels-mongolia-talks-indefinitely-after-dalai-lama-visit>

³ "China slaps new fees on Mongolian exporters amid Dalai Lama row." *CNBC*, December 1st, 2016.

<https://www.cnbc.com/2016/12/01/china-slaps-new-fees-on-mongolian-exporters-amid-dalai-lama-row.html>.

⁴ Dussault, Joseph. "Why the Dalai Lama is no longer welcome in Mongolia." *Christian Science Monitor*, December 22nd, 2016. <https://www.csmonitor.com/World/2016/1222/Why-the-Dalai-Lama-is-no-longer-welcome-in-Mongolia>

⁵ Yu, Li. "The Dalai Lama's visit to Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, is another tightrope walk." *DW News*, November 17th, 2016.

<https://www.dw.com/zh/%E8%BE%BE%E8%B5%96%E5%96%87%E5%98%9B%E5%88%B0%E8%AE%BF%E4%B9%8C%E5%85%B0%E5%B7%B4%E6%89%98-%E8%92%99%E5%8F%A4%E5%8F%88%E5%BE%97%E8%B5%B0%E9%92%A2%E4%B8%9D/a-36431264>

⁶ *Ibid.*

⁷ "Dalai Lama's Visit to Mongolia Could Fray Its Ties to China." *The New York Times*, November 19th, 2016.

https://www.nytimes.com/2016/11/20/world/asia/mongolia-dalai-lama-china.html?_r=0.

⁸ "China slaps new fees on Mongolian exporters amid Dalai Lama row." *CNBC*, December 1st, 2016.

<https://www.cnbc.com/2016/12/01/china-slaps-new-fees-on-mongolian-exporters-amid-dalai-lama-row.html>.

copper concentrate worth more than 10,000 yuan per ton.⁹ China denied the connection between the new taxes and the Dalai Lama visit.¹⁰ These fees were first reported on 2016/12/01.¹¹ By 2016/12/10, hundreds of trucks from the mining conglomerate Rio Tinto were stuck at the Gants Mod crossing.¹²

On 2016/12/20, Mongolian Foreign Minister Tsend Munkh-Orgil told domestic newspaper *Unuudur* that the country would “never receive the Dalai Lama again.”¹³ Reports suggested that Mongolia’s dependence on the Chinese economy – in particular its ongoing attempts to secure a \$4.2 billion loan from Beijing to pull its economy out of a significant slump – forced Ulaanbaatar to restrict the Dalai Lama’s travel.¹⁴

⁹ *Ibid.*

¹⁰ *Ibid.*

¹¹ *Ibid.*

¹² “China ‘blocks’ Mongolia border after Dalai Lama visit.” *Al Jazeera*, December 10th, 2016.

<https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/2016/12/10/china-blocks-mongolia-border-after-dalai-lama-visit>.

¹³ Dussault, Joseph. “Why the Dalai Lama is no longer welcome in Mongolia.” *Christian Science Monitor*, December 22nd, 2016.

<https://www.csmonitor.com/World/2016/1222/Why-the-Dalai-Lama-is-no-longer-welcome-in-Mongolia>

¹⁴ *Ibid.*